IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 10

Science and Technology

The technology we use, the future and describing a graph

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 10 · Book pp. 114–123

LEARNING GOAL

Talk about technology, predict the future and describe a graph

Objectives: you will...

- identify different types of technology
- paraphrase and reformulate information
- understand factual information in a lecture
- use will for the future
- describe changes in a graph
- speak about a gadget

Success criteria: I can...

- spell technology words correctly
- find the paraphrase in the text
- notice an option with the opposite meaning
- use will / won’t for predictions
- use rise, increase, fall, decrease
- give years and numbers when I describe a graph

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

SPELLING

Spell words **correctly** in exams, or you lose marks.

Tip 03, p. 115

READING

One-to-three-word answers: the sentence **paraphrases** the text.

box and Tip 06, p. 116

READING

Watch for **opposites**: the opposite of difficult is easy.

Mini tips 06.0–06.1, p. 116

WRITING

Learn words for **changes**: rise, increase, fall, decrease.

Tip 12, p. 118

LEAD-IN

Which do you use?

smartphone

laptop

tablet

smart watch

Which do you use for studying, contacting friends and searching the internet?

VOCABULARY · TECHNOLOGY

Spell it right

Which is correct?

crushed / **crashed** / crached

Which is correct?

wepsites / **websites** / websits

Which is correct?

devices / divices / devises

Words

attachment · backup · download · store · stream · network

IELTS STRATEGY

Spell words **correctly** in exams, otherwise you **lose marks**.

READING · PARAPHRASING

Same meaning, different words

Text: “It takes information and sends it from one computer to another. It is not a difficult job, but it is a very big one.”

Sending information from one computer to another is **an easy job**.

not difficult = **easy**

IELTS STRATEGY

The sentence **rewrites** the text in different words.

Use one to three words. Watch for **opposites**.

LISTENING 1 · A SHORT LECTURE

Facts, numbers and spelling

Parts of a smartphone: touch screen display, power button, USB input...

Reasons for the parts: *to turn the phone on and off*

Table: % of the population with smartphones, 2010–2025

IELTS STRATEGY

Paraphrasing matters in **Listening** too.

Be careful with **spelling**: a wrong spelling is a wrong answer.

GRAMMAR · WILL FOR THE FUTURE

Predictions with will

	person / thing	will / won’t	verb
Positive	People	will	be richer than they are now.
Negative	Phones	won’t	be the same in 2050.
Question	Will	cars	fly one day?
Wh- question	What will	phones	look like?

will + verb: not “wills”, “will to go”, or “willn’t”. Add *I’m sure* / *maybe* / *probably*.

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Find the mistake

× Mistake	✓ Correct	Why
People **will to** drive flying cars.	People **will** drive flying cars.	no to after will
Robots **wills** do housework.	Robots **will** do housework.	will never takes -s
Phones **willn’t** be expensive.	Phones **won’t** be expensive.	negative: won’t
Do people will read books?	**Will people** read books?	question: Will + subject
In 2015, it **rises** to 50%.	In 2015, it **rose** to 50%.	past year: past simple



Find the mistake, say the rule, then write the correct sentence.

VOCABULARY · DESCRIBING CHANGE

Up and down

Verb	Past	Noun
rise	rose	a rise
increase	increased	an increase
go up	went up	—
fall	fell	a fall
decrease	decreased	a decrease
go down	went down	—

IELTS STRATEGY Learn words for **changes**, especially when numbers get **bigger** or **smaller**.

WRITING · NUMBERS AND YEARS

From … to … · by …

It **rose from** 38% in 2010 **to** 62% in 2015. (from = the start · to = the end)

It **increased by** 24%. (by = the amount of change)

It **will continue to** rise to 86% in 2025. (will = a prediction)

Draw the line from the table in Ex 9, then choose A, B or C in Ex 14.

WRITING · DESCRIBING A GRAPH

Overview, details, prediction

1 · What

The graph shows the percentage of…

2 · Overview

Overall, … rose, but … fell.

3 · Details

Years and numbers: rose from … to …

4 · Future

It will probably rise to …

Use both verbs (**rose**) and nouns (**a rise of 10%**). Check every number.

WRITING · MODEL

A model description (about 85 words)

The graph shows the percentage of students who bring a laptop to school from 2018 to 2026.

Overall, the percentage **rose**, apart from a small **fall** in 2022.

In 2018, only 20% of students brought a laptop. This figure **increased** to 45% in 2020. It then **fell slightly** to 40% in 2022, but **went up** again to 60% in 2024.

Experts think the percentage **will rise** to 75% in 2026. This shows that more students are using laptops for their studies.

LISTENING 2 · DESCRIBING A GADGET

Lorenzo’s answer

Describe a piece of technology you would like to buy in the future.

Listen: what does he want to buy?

Match the underlined words with their meanings.

Match the questions to his answers.

Ex 18 meanings

important parts of a device · the newest device · move your finger across · old · stores data

SPEAKING · DESCRIBING A GADGET

Your turn: two minutes

You should say: what it is · what it looks like · how much it costs

and explain why you want to buy it.

Use **will**: *It will help me…* · *I will use it to…*

Partner: listen and ask one follow-up question at the end.

PAIR PRACTICE

Your turn, together

Student A

Describe a gadget you would like to buy: what it is, what it looks like, how much it costs and why you want it.

Student B

Describe a gadget you use every day: what it is, what you use it for and how it will change in the future.

Two minutes to prepare, one minute to talk. Your partner asks one question with will.

REVIEW

Can you…?

- ✓ spell technology words correctly
- ✓ find a paraphrase in the text
- ✓ catch numbers in a lecture
- ✓ make predictions with will
- ✓ describe a rise and a fall
- ✓ talk about a gadget for two minutes

Next: the Unit 10 Challenge on the Miss L Gems site.